weather hazards through natural buffers such as wetlands. Pollination is another key regulating service, one that is endangered by the global decline of pollinators such as bees. Cultural services involve the ways that humans assign cultural or spiritual significance to elements of ecosystems such as sacred trees, animals, rivers, and mountains, and the esthetic or recreational value of a natural landscape.

The concept of NCP allows humans to see how inextricably connected they are to nature, and how without the natural world human existence would be impossible. Ecologists use the concept to show how precious these systems are for basic life conditions and to convince industries, businesses, and governments of the necessity for ecological preservation.

“Plans to protect air and water, wilderness and wildlife are in fact plans to protect man.”

Stewart Udall

American politician and conservationist
